

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

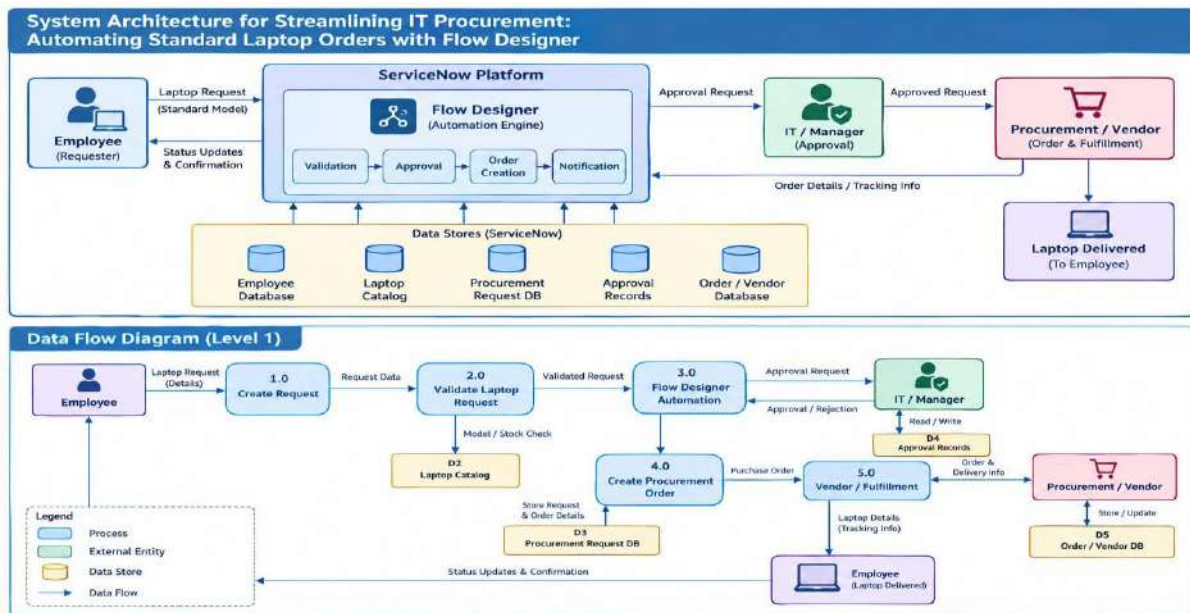
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1.Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to: Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.

1. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
2. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
3. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

2. System Architecture



3. System Requirements

For “Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders”, the main system requirements are:

3.1. Hardware Requirements

- Computer/Laptop with minimum 4 GB RAM.
- Stable internet connecti
- Flow Designer for workflow automation.
- Web browser such as Chrome, Edge, or Firefox.
- Database for storing employee, laptop, request, approval, and order details.

3.2. Functional Requirements

- Employee can submit a standard laptop request.
- System validates the request and laptop availability.
- Automatically sends the request for manager/IT approval.
- Creates a procurement order after approval.
- Sends notifications and tracks order status.
- Maintains procurement records.

4. Security Requirements

- User authentication and role-based access.
- Only authorized users can approve or manage orders.
- Secure storage of employee and procurement data.

5. Performance Requirements

- Requests should be processed quickly.
- Automated workflows should reduce manual procurement work.
- System should support multiple requests simultaneously.

6. Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

User Story:

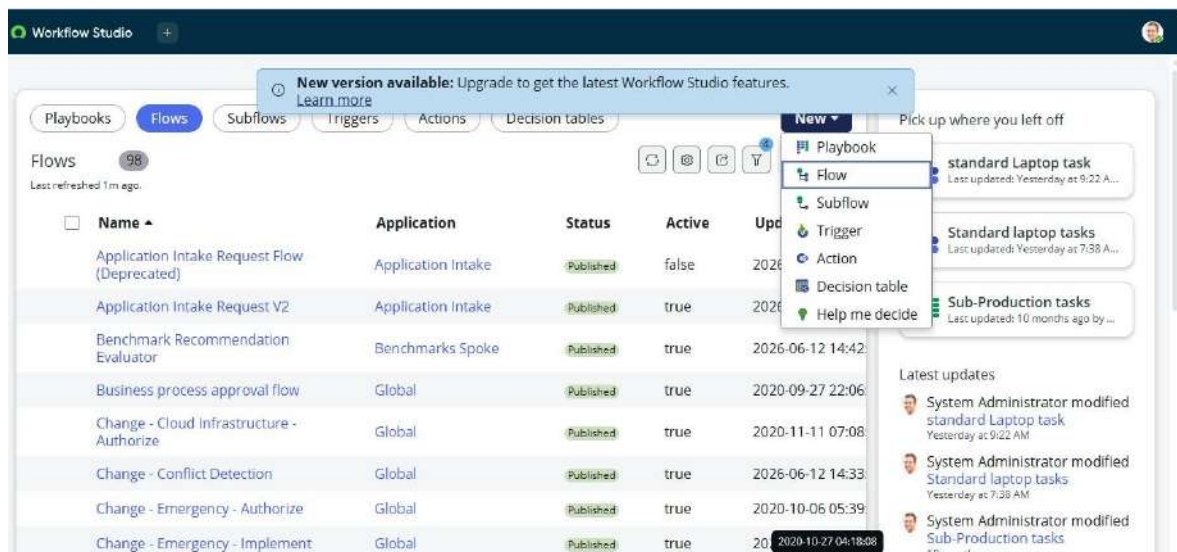
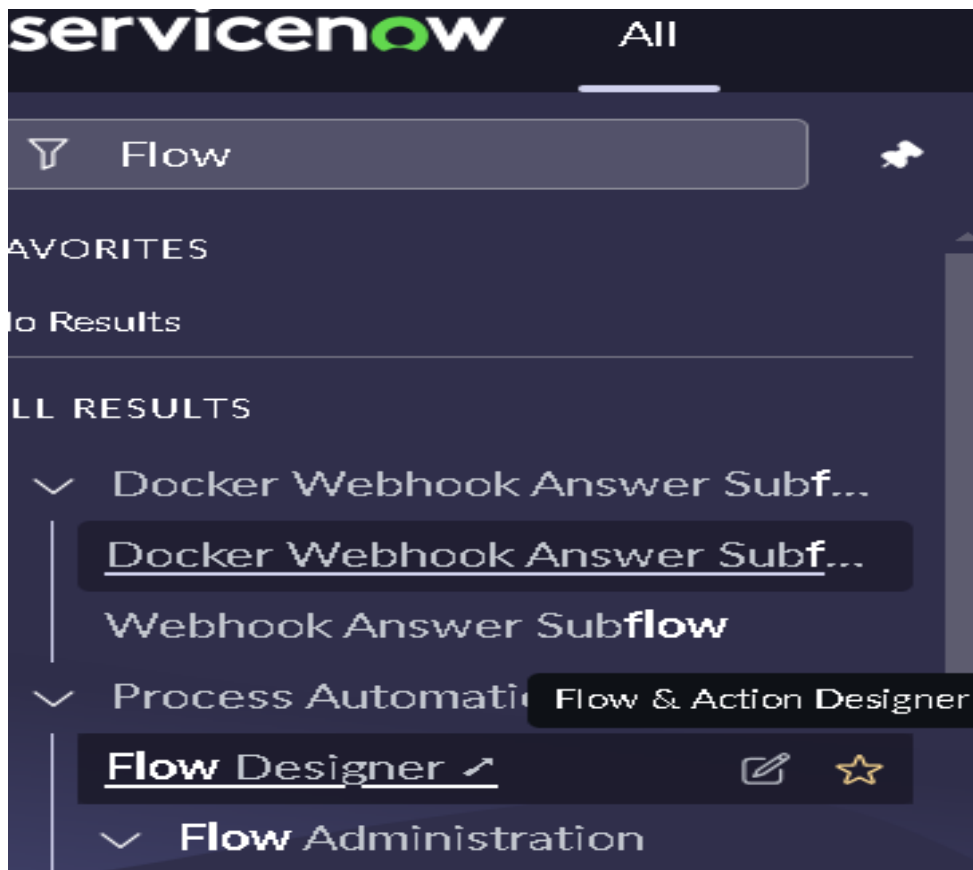
As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

7. TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

4. Open service now.
5. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
6. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
7. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
8. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
9. Application should be Global.
10. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
11. Click on Submit.



Workflow Studio

New Flow
Flow: None

Let's get the details for your flow

Flow name ✕ 🔍
Standard laptop task

Application ✕ 🔍
Global

Description 🔍
Describe your flow.

[Show additional properties](#)

Cancel Build flow

12. Click on Add a trigger

13. Select the trigger in that Search for “ Service Catalog ” and select that.

14. After that click on Done.

Flow VPN x Flow Email sending for P1 x Flow Standard laptop task x

Standard laptop task Inactive View: 🔍 🔍

TRIGGER

✕ Abort trigger creation

Trigger Select a Trigger

Search triggers

RECORD

Created

Updated

Created or Updated

DATE

Daily

Created

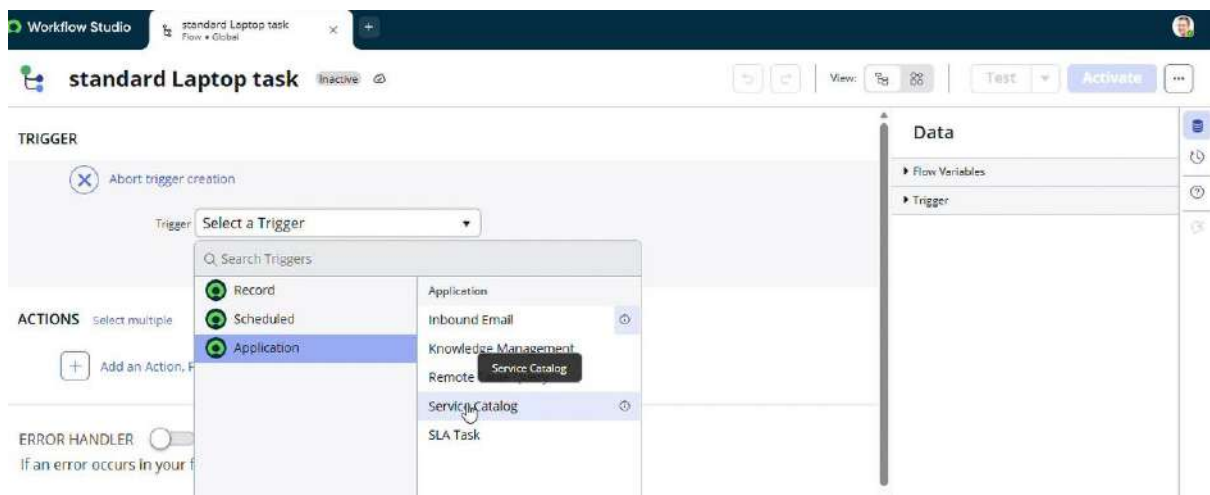
Trigger initiates from a ServiceNow record creation that meets the condition filter.

ACTIONS

+ Add an Action, Flow

ERROR HANDLER

15. Now under Actions.
16. Click on Add an action.
17. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
18. Mention these in that action
19. Action as Create Catalog Task
20. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
21. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
22. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
23. Click on add field value
24. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
25. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
26. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
27. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
28. Click on save the Flow.
29. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.



Workflow Studio standard Laptop task Flow Global

standard Laptop task Inactive

Action: Create Catalog Task

Action Inputs

Table Name: Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested Item [Requested Item]: Trigger ... Requested Item ...

Short Description: Laptop need a configured

Description: Laptop need a configured

Assignment group: Hardware

Approval: Approved

+ Add field value

Wait: ☒

Data

Flow Variables

Trigger - Service Catalog

Requested Item Record	Record
Run Start Time UTC	Date/Time
Run Start Date/Time	Date/Time
Table Name	Table Name

1 - Create Catalog Task

Catalog Task	Record
Action Status	Object

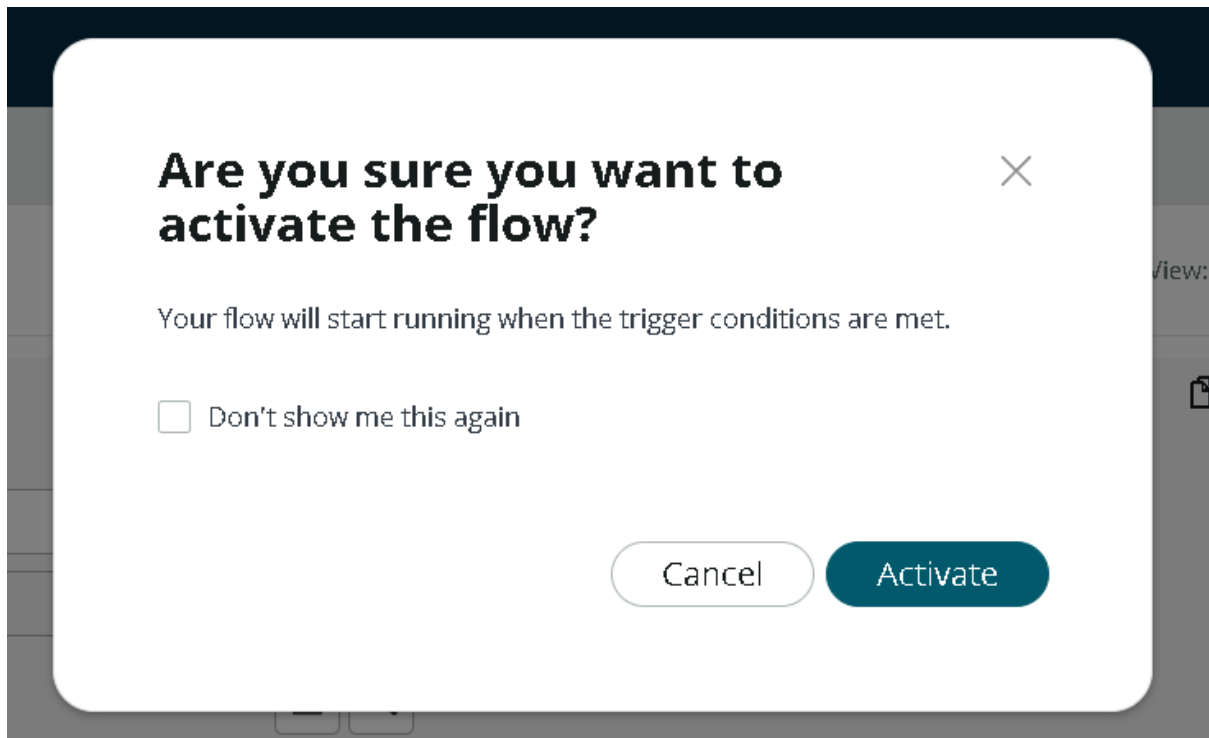
TRIGGER

now Service Catalog

Trigger: Service Catalog

Advanced Options

Delete Cancel Done



Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

30. Open ServiceNow.
31. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
32. Select Maintain Items.
33. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
34. Under that record select Process engine
35. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
36. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
37. Click on the menu to save the record.

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - CarbonX1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2024-04-16 04:14:53
Standard 27\" Monitor	Size- 27\" Resolution- 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 22\" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24\" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33

Catalog Item
Standard Laptop

Name: Standard Laptop

Application: Global

Catalogs: Service Catalog

Category: Hardware

State: -- None --

Checked out: -- None --

Owner:

Active: ☒

Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified

Item Details | **Process Engine** | Picture | Pricing | Portal Settings

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow: Standard Laptop task

Workflow:

Execution Plan:

Update | Copy | Try It | **Edit in Catalog Builder** | Delete

Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

38. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
39. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
40. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
41. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.

[Favorites](#)
[History](#)
[Workspaces](#)
[Admin](#)
Standard Laptop

[Service Catalog](#) > [Hardware](#) > [Standard Laptop](#)

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

☐ Adobe Acrobat

☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

Order this Item

Price ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Quantity

Subtotal ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Delivery [Order Now](#) 0 Days

[Order Now](#)

[Add to Cart](#)

Shopping Cart

Empty

42. Now we will see the Order status

43. In that click on the Request Number

Order Status [Back to Catalog](#) [Continue Shopping](#) [Home](#)

✓ Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2024-04-17 04:07:11

Request Number: [REQ0010001](#) ☆

Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2024-04-17

Description (Includes Annual Charges)	Delivery Date	Stage	Price (ea.)	Quantity	Total
Lenovo - Carbon x1	2024-04-17	▶	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually	1	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually
				Total	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

[Back to Catalog](#)
[Continue Shopping](#)
[Home](#)

44. It will open the Requested number record.

45. Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

servicenow All [Favorites](#) [History](#) [Admin](#) Request - REQ0010005

Request REQ0010005 [Discuss](#) [Follow](#) [Update](#) [Add New Item](#) [Cancel Request](#) [Copy](#) [Delete](#)

Number

Requested for

Location

Due date

Price

Description

Short description

Special instructions

Work notes

Opened

Opened by

Approval

Request state

☐ Comments (Customer visible) [Post](#)

46. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

servicenow All Favorites History Admin Request - REQ0010005 Search

Request REQ0010005 Discuss Follow Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Number REQ0010005 Opened 2026-09-23 00:51:48

Requested for System Administrator Opened by System Administrator

Location

Due date 2026-09-23 00:51:47

Approval Requested

Request state Pending Approval

Price \$1,100.00

Description

Short description

Special instructions

Work notes Work notes

☐ Comments (Customer visible) Post

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Requested Items (1) Approvers (1) Group approvals (1) Recurring Prices (1)

State Search Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approval for = REQ0010005

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Approved	Eric Schroeder		2026-09-23 00:51:51

1 to 1 of 1

47. Then click on the Requested item Section
48. Open that Requested Item record
49. Scroll down to the " Catalog tasks " Section
50. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

[Favorites](#)
[History](#)
[Workspaces](#)
[Admin](#)

Requested Item - RITM0010001

Search

Requested Item RITM0010001

[Discuss](#)
[Follow](#)
[Update](#)
[Delete](#)

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Impact

Opened by

Priority

State

3 - Low

System Administrator

4 - Low

Open

Field changes • 2024-04-17 04:07:10

[Update](#)
[Delete](#)

Related Links

[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1)

Approvers

Group approvals

Number

Search

Actions on selected rows...

New

Request item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	

1 to 1 of 1

8. Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.